

Ten Useful Commands in Linux



That the power of Linux lies in its command line is an oft repeated statement and newbies need to be introduced to it. This article lists the top 10 commands in Linux.

Graphical user interfaces (GUIs) are helpful for many tasks, but they are not good for all purposes. Computers were supposed to free us from manual labour, but how often have you performed some task that you felt sure the computer ought to be able to do, instead of you tediously working the mouse. Pointing and clicking, pointing and clicking.

The Linux GUI runs on the shell. When the GUI is not running, the shell is — Linux is running. But if the shell is not running, nothing is. Commands in Linux are a means of interacting with the shell.

```
anjali@anjali-Lenovo-IdeaPad-S510p:~$ uptime
10:30:54 up 58 min, 2 users, load average: 0.10, 0.31, 0.29
anjali@anjali-Lenovo-IdeaPad-S510p:~$
```

Figure 1: The *uptime* command shows how long the system has been running

```
anjali@anjali-Lenovo-IdeaPad-S510p:~$ who
anjali  :0          2015-12-31 09:41 (:0)
anjali  pts/1      2015-12-31 10:37 (:0)
anjali@anjali-Lenovo-IdeaPad-S510p:~$
```

Figure 2: The *who* command prints information about the users who are currently logged in

```
anjali@anjali-Lenovo-IdeaPad-S510p:~$ ssh new@192.168.50.2
```

Figure 3: SSH connects and logs into the specified hostname. Users must prove their identity to the remote machine

Here are the top 10 commands for systems and network administration.

1. The *uptime* command

In Linux, the *uptime* command shows since when your system has been running, the number of users that are currently logged in and also displays the load average for 1, 5 and 15 minute intervals.

2. The *who* command

The *who* command returns the user name, date, time and host information.

The *(:0)* tells you which display you're using. *Pts* means pseudoterminal master and slave.

3. The *SSH* command

The secure shell (SSH) command is used to log in to the remote host. The SSH client is a program for logging into and executing commands on a remote machine. It provides secure encrypted communications between two untrusted hosts over an insecure network.

4. The *Ftp* or *sftp* commands

Ftp or *sftp* commands are used to connect to a remote *ftp* host. *Ftp* is (file transfer protocol) and *sftp* is (secure file transfer protocol). For example, the command in Figure 4 will connect to the *ftp* host (192.168.50.2).